

Gautam Velpula

Head of Engineering

Consumer Products • AI-Native Engineering • Fintech & Payments

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Executive Summary

Engineering leader with 12+ years of experience building and scaling teams that deliver high-quality consumer products across web, mobile, and backend platforms. Deep hands-on expertise in Node.js, TypeScript, React, and Firebase with a strong perspective on maintaining engineering rigor in an AI-accelerated environment. Currently leading enterprise-wide adoption of AI-native engineering workflows and LLM-powered development practices. Proven ability to manage cross-functional, multi-location teams while sustaining high velocity, collaborative culture, and technical excellence.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture & Platform Engineering

- Led engineering strategy and day-to-day technical direction across a multi-brand consumer organization, managing principal and lead engineers while partnering closely with Product, Design, and Operations to align on goals and delivery.
- Defined and executed a unified consumer platform consolidating 7 brand apps (web and mobile) into a shared architecture, dramatically reducing development costs and accelerating feature velocity across the portfolio.
- Re-architected backend systems to a microservices and event-driven model using **Node.js, TypeScript, and NestJS**, standardizing APIs and service contracts for scalability and team independence.
- Built consumer-facing applications on **Next.js, React Native, and Firebase**, delivering cross-platform experiences across web and mobile.
- Drove adoption of **AI-native engineering workflows** (Claude Code, Cursor, LLM-assisted development) across engineering teams—defining patterns, guardrails, and best practices to amplify output while maintaining strict code quality and architectural integrity.
- Led design and implementation of **agentic AI capabilities** in consumer-facing products and internal tooling, using LLMs to automate repetitive tasks and accelerate development cycles without sacrificing reliability or security.
- Partnered with security and compliance to establish governance standards for AI-assisted development, balancing speed with system reliability.
- Designed and delivered payments integration with FreedomPay, enabling digital wallets and modern checkout—directly supporting fintech-adjacent product growth.
- Architected and delivered a subscription service supporting recurring-revenue business models, including hands-on development of a critical stop-gap service during a system failure.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through platform modernization and engineering process improvements.
- Scaled engineering processes including cycle planning, prioritization, hiring, and cross-team communication across a distributed organization.
- Built a high-performing, collaborative engineering culture rooted in trust, autonomy, and continuous improvement.

Slalom Consulting
Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Led multi-million-dollar digital transformation and cloud modernization engagements for Fortune 500 clients in fintech, eCommerce, and consumer technology.
- Directed cross-functional, multi-location teams spanning engineering, product, and design across multi-year engagements—maintaining high velocity and quality across distributed teams.
- Conducted a multi-year enterprise assessment of a legacy platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture and modernization roadmap.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP for a leading payments and point-of-sale provider.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps practices, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Mentored delivery leaders and engineering managers, building leadership bench strength and scaling team capabilities.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)
Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery, managing cross-functional and multi-location engineering teams serving Fortune 500 clients.
- Directly managed and developed senior engineers and team leads, setting clear goals and building a high-performing, collaborative team.
- Held end-to-end accountability for delivery, scaling engineering processes including hiring, prioritization, and internal communication.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, aligning technical delivery with business objectives.
- Built and scaled a global engineering services organization through recruiting, mentoring, and standardized practices.

Technology Stack

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, NestJS, Next.js, React, React Native, Java (Spring Boot), Tailwind CSS

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Functions, API Management), Google Cloud Platform, Firebase, Vercel, Cloudflare

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB, Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

AI & Dev Tooling: Claude Code, Cursor, LLM integration patterns, agentic AI architectures, AI governance frameworks

Engineering Practices: CI/CD, DevOps, observability (Splunk, GA4, Firebase Analytics), data-driven product iteration

Core Strengths

Consumer Product Engineering • AI-Native Engineering Workflows • Cross-Platform Development (Web, Mobile, Backend) • Multi-Location Team Leadership • Fintech & Payments • Engineering Process Scaling • Collaborative Culture Building • Recruiting & Team Design

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology
George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

2007 – 2009

